Content calendar template: 3-month plan

An SEO content plan for your blog and website. Each row is one piece of content with a primary keyword, search intent, format, target URL, internal links, an owner and Google Search Console results at 30 and 90 days.

How to use this template

1. **Set the basics** (part 1): the goal for the quarter, the audience, the service pages to support and a cadence your team can actually keep.
2. **Build the topic backlog** (part 2) from Search Console, keyword research, customer questions and competitor gaps. Score each topic from 1 to 3.
3. **Give each topic one primary keyword** and search it on Google to see which pages rank in the top ten. That tells you the intent and the format.
4. **Lay out the calendar** (part 3): month 1 – service pages and FAQs, month 2 – articles and comparisons, month 3 – case studies and updates.
5. **Run the checklist before publishing** (part 5), and on publish day add the 30-day and 90-day check dates.
6. **Measure and decide** (part 4): filter the Search Console Performance report by URL, log the results and your decision. Review the quarter at the end.

1. Plan basics

1 **Content goal for this quarter** (for example, more inquiries for one service)

2 **Audience** (who they are, what problem they have, where they are in the decision)

3 **Service pages your articles should lead to** (URLs)

4 **Cadence**

new pieces per month

updates per month

5 **Owner and review**

calendar owner (one person)

quarterly review date

The quarter at a glance

Month 1: foundations
Service pages and FAQs for transactional and local keywords. Without them, articles have nowhere to send traffic.

Month 2: support
Informational articles and comparisons that answer pre-purchase questions and link to your service pages.

Month 3: proof and updates
Case studies, refreshes of pages losing clicks, and the first check of month-1 content.

2. Topic backlog

Topics waiting for a slot. Score each one from 1 to 3: **V** – business value, **C** – chance to rank, **E** – effort (3 = high). Topics with the highest V + C and the lowest E go into the calendar first.

#	Topic	Primary keyword	Intent	Idea source	V	C	E	For month
e.g.	*How much does heat pump installation cost?*	*heat pump installation cost*	*commercial*	*customer questions*	*3*	*2*	*2*	*2*
1								
2								
3								
4								
5								
6								
7								
8								
9								
10								
11								
12								
13								
14								

Where to find topics

- [ ] **Search Console:** Performance report, Queries tab, sorted by impressions. Queries with impressions but few clicks.
- [ ] **Keyword research:** how customers describe your services and what they ask. Keywords with the same intent make one topic.
- [ ] **Customer questions:** from calls, emails and sales meetings. A question that keeps coming up is a topic for an FAQ or an article.
- [ ] **Competitor gaps:** topics that businesses ranking above you cover and you don't.

3. Content calendar

Intent: informational, commercial, transactional, local. Format: article, service page, FAQ, case study, comparison, update. Status: idea → brief → writing → editing → ready → published → needs update.

Month 1 · foundations · from _____ to _____

Week / date	Topic	Primary keyword	Intent	Format	Target URL	Internal links	Owner	Status	Publish date
e.g. Jan 14	*Heat pump installation in [city]*	*heat pump installation [city]*	*local*	*service page*	*/heat-pump-installation*	*from: home page*	*Anna*	*brief*	*Jan 16*
Week 1									
Week 2									
Week 3									
Week 4									
Update									

Month 2 · support · from _____ to _____

Week / date	Topic	Primary keyword	Intent	Format	Target URL	Internal links	Owner	Status	Publish date
Week 1									
Week 2									
Week 3									
Week 4									
Update									

Rule: one primary keyword, one URL. In the Internal links column, every article names the service page it points to.

Month 3 · proof and updates · from _____ to _____

Week / date	Topic	Primary keyword	Intent	Format	Target URL	Internal links	Owner	Status	Publish date
Week 1									
Week 2									
Week 3									
Week 4									
Update									

4. Results sheet (Google Search Console)

Performance report → Page filter with the URL from your plan → date range starting on the publish date. Log clicks, impressions and average position at 30 and at 90 days. On the Queries tab, check whether the page shows up for the primary keyword in your plan.

Target URL	Publish date	Primary keyword	Clicks at 30 days	Impressions at 30 days	Clicks at 90 days	Impressions at 90 days	Avg. position at 90 days	Decision

Your decision at 90 days

No impressions
Check indexing with the URL Inspection tool and add internal links.

Impressions for the keyword, few clicks
Rewrite the title and meta description, expand the content, add links from strong pages.

Impressions for other queries
Change the keyword in the plan or rewrite the piece for the original intent.

Two URLs for the same keyword
Merge the pages (301 redirect) or separate their intents.

5. Pre-publish checklist

- [ ] The primary keyword is in the page title, the H1 and the first paragraph.
- [ ] The content matches the intent you see in Google's top ten results.
- [ ] No other URL on the site targets the same keyword.
- [ ] At least two existing pages link to the new piece.
- [ ] The new piece links to the right service page.
- [ ] The meta description says what the reader will find and gives a reason to click.
- [ ] The publish date is in the calendar, and the 30-day and 90-day check dates are in the team calendar.
- [ ] For updates: the "last updated" date changes only when the content has really changed.

Quarterly review

1. **Which pieces earned the most clicks at 90 days, and why?**

2. **Which pieces did not deliver, and what did you decide** (expand, rewrite the title, merge)**?**

3. **Did you keep the cadence? If not, what cadence will you set for next quarter?**

4. **Which pages are losing clicks year over year in Search Console and need an update?**

5. **Backlog topics for next quarter's calendar** (numbers from part 2)

> Search Console keeps data for the last 16 months, so you can compare year over year without exporting. Save older data in a spreadsheet.